PADHAKU
Exploring Society: India and Beyond · Class 6 Social Science



CHAPTER 5

India, That Is Bharat

NCERT Exercise Solutions

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✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡 answers are samples: write your own.

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❓ The Big Questions

1 How do we define India?

✔ ANSWER

India is the land between the Himalayas in the north and the seas in the south, east and west — the Indian Subcontinent.

Today it is a modern nation with defined borders, states and a known population, but its name and boundaries changed over history.

2 What were the ancient names for India?

✔ ANSWER

- Indian names: **Sapta Sindhava** (the northwest, in the Ṛig Veda), **Bhāratavarṣha**, **Jambudvīpa** and **Bhārata**.
- Foreign names: **Hind / Hidu / Hindu** (Persian), **Indoi / Indike** (Greek), **Yintu / Yindu / Tianzhu** (Chinese), **Hindustān**.

🤔 Think About It · Natural boundaries

? Look at the physical map of the Indian Subcontinent at the start of the chapter. What natural boundaries can you make out?

✔ ANSWER

- **North:** the Himalayas (and the Hindu Kush in the northwest).

- **West:** the Arabian Sea.
- **East:** the Bay of Bengal.
- **South:** the Indian Ocean.

So the Subcontinent is bounded by high mountains in the north and by seas on the other three sides.

⭐ Let's Explore · Regions in the Mahābhārata

? Do you recognise the names of any regions given in the map (Fig. 5.4)? List the ones that you have heard of.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sample list: Kashmir (Kāshmīra), Kurukṣhetra, Vanga (Bengal), Prāgjyotiṣha (Assam), Kaccha (Kutch), Kerala, Magadha, Kosala, Kāshī, Gāndhāra, Vidarbha, Surāṣhṭra (Saurashtra), Chola, Pāṇḍya.

(Your list may be different: write the names you have heard of.)

🤔 Think About It · The snowy mountains

? Have you identified the 'snowy mountains'? Do you think this brief description of Bhārata is correct?

✔ ANSWER

The 'snowy mountains' are the **Himalayas**.

Yes, the description is correct: India lies north of the ocean (Indian Ocean) and south of the Himalayas.

⭐ Let's Explore · The Constitution

? In the first page of the original Constitution of India (Fig. 5.5), can you make out the phrase 'India, that is Bharat'?

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Yes. Article 1 at the start says: **"India, that is Bharat, shall be a Union of States."** (check the picture in your book)

⭐ Let's Explore · Many names of India

? Complete this table of the many names of India:

Language	Name
Persian	?
Greek	?
Latin	India
Chinese	?
Arabic & Persian	?
English	India
French	Inde

✔ ANSWER

Language	Name
Persian	**Hind, Hidu, Hindu**
Greek	**Indoi, Indike**
Latin	India
Chinese	**Yintu, Yindu** (also Tianzhu)
Arabic & Persian	**Hindustān**
English	India
French	Inde

? Questions, activities and projects

1 **Discuss what could be the meaning of the quotation at the start of the chapter (Sri Aurobindo).**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Sri Aurobindo says that very early in history, the people living between the Himalayas and the two seas came to share one spiritual and cultural unity.

This unity became part of their daily life. So, though India has many regions and languages, its people are joined by a common culture.

2 (i) **True or false? The Ṛig Veda describes the entire geography of India.**

✔ ANSWER

False. It names only the northwest region, 'Sapta Sindhava' (land of the seven rivers).

2 (ii) **The Viṣhṇu Purāṇa describes the entire Subcontinent.**

✔ ANSWER

True. It calls the land north of the ocean and south of the snowy mountains 'Bhārata'.

2 (iii) **In Aśhoka's time, 'Jambudvīpa' included what is today India, parts of Afghanistan, Bangladesh and Pakistan.**

✔ ANSWER

True.

2 (iv) **The Mahābhārata lists many regions, including Kashmir, Kutch, and Kerala.**

✔ ANSWER

True. It names Kāshmīra, Kaccha, Kerala and many more.

2 (v) **The term 'Hindustān' first appeared in a Greek inscription more than 2,000 years ago.**

✔ ANSWER

False. It first appeared in a **Persian** inscription about **1,800** years ago.

2 (vi) **In ancient Persian, the word 'Hindu' refers to the Hindu religion.**

✔ ANSWER

False. In ancient Persian, 'Hindu' is a purely geographical term (from 'Sindhu').

2 (vii) **'Bhārata' is a name given to India by foreign travellers.**

✔ ANSWER

False. 'Bhārata' was given by Indians themselves, in Indian texts. Foreigners used names from 'Sindhu'.

3 **If you were born some 2,000 years ago and had the chance to name our country, what name or names might you have chosen, and why? Use your imagination!**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

I might have chosen **'Bhāratavarṣha'** or **'Jambudvīpa'**.

- Bhāratavarṣha: the country of the Bharatas, a name already known across the land.
- Jambudvīpa: the jamun tree grows all over India, so it is a name everyone could relate to.

(Any name with a good reason is fine.)

4 **Why did people travel to India from various parts of the world in ancient times? What could be their motivations? (Hint: at least four or five)**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

- **Trade:** to buy spices, cotton cloth, gems and other goods.
- **Religion / pilgrimage:** e.g. Buddhist monks like Xuanzang came to the land of the Buddha.
- **Learning:** to meet scholars and study at Indian centres of learning, and collect texts (manuscripts).
- **Conquest:** rulers like the Persian emperor came to gain control of land and wealth.
- **Curiosity and exploration:** to see and describe a rich, famous land.
- **Settling:** to find a better life in a fertile land.

🎉 **Chapter 5 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**